

Equipment Reservation and Usage Policy

1. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to ensure fair, safe, and efficient use of shared technical equipment managed through the Equipment Reservation and Asset Tracking System. The policy applies to all users who reserve, borrow, or administer equipment within the system.

2. User Roles

2.1 Student and Staff

Students and staff may:

- View the availability of equipment
- Create reservations
- Check out and return equipment assigned to them
- View their reservation history

Students may not:

- Modify equipment records
 - Access other users' reservations
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2.2 Administrator

Administrators may:

- Manage users and permissions
 - Add, modify, or archive equipment
 - Override reservations when necessary
 - Access all reservation and equipment records
 - Generate reports, QR codes and usage statistics
 - Check returned requests and approve them
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3. Reservation Rules

3.1 Reservation Eligibility

Only registered and active users may create reservations.

Users with suspended accounts may not reserve equipment.

3.2 Reservation Duration

Default reservation durations:

Category	Maximum Reservation Period
VR Equipment	24 hours
Audio/ Video Equipment	72 hours
Robotics Kits	7 days
Laboratory Instruments	2 days
IoT and embedded systems	24 hours
Computing Equipment	24 hours

Administrators may modify these limits based on operational requirements.

3.3 Reservation Limits

Each user may have:

- Maximum 3 active reservations simultaneously

These limits may vary for staff members.

3.4 Reservation Confirmation

A reservation becomes active only after successful confirmation within the system.

3.5 Reservation Conflicts

The system automatically prevents overlapping reservations for the same equipment.

If a conflict exists:

- The reservation request will be rejected.
 - The user must select another reservation time.
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4. Equipment Checkout

4.1 Identification

Users must identify themselves using:

- Institutional credentials
 - Student ID card
 - Approved authentication method
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4.2 QR-Code Verification

When QR-code functionality is available:

- Users must scan the equipment QR code during checkout.
 - The system records checkout time automatically.
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4.3 Equipment Condition

Before checkout, users must verify that:

- Equipment is complete
- No visible damage exists
- Required accessories are included

Any issues must be reported immediately.

5. Equipment Return Process

5.1 Return Request Submission

Users cannot directly complete a return.

To initiate the return process:

1. The user scans the equipment QR code.
2. The user selects Request Return in the system.
3. A return request is created.
4. Equipment status changes to Pending Inspection.

The reservation remains active until the inspection process is completed.

5.2 Inspection Requirement

All returned equipment must be inspected by an authorized Administrator.

The inspection process verifies:

- Physical condition of the equipment
 - Functionality of the equipment
 - Presence of all required accessories
 - Cleanliness and usability
 - Absence of unauthorized modifications
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5.3 Return Approval

If the equipment passes inspection:

1. The Administrator approves the return request.
2. The reservation is closed.
3. The return time stamp is recorded.
4. Equipment status changes to Available.
5. An audit log entry is generated.

The equipment becomes available for future reservations only after approval.

5.4 Return Rejection

If the equipment fails inspection:

1. The Administrator rejects the return request.
2. Inspection notes are recorded.
3. The user receives a notification explaining the reason for rejection.
4. Equipment status remains unavailable until the issue is resolved.

Examples of rejection reasons include:

- Missing accessories
 - Physical damage
 - Equipment malfunction
 - Missing cables or adapters
 - Unauthorized modifications
 - Excessive dirt or contamination
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5.5 Late Returns

Equipment must be physically returned before the reservation end time.

Submitting a return request does not exempt the user from late-return policies.

Late returns may result in:

- Warning notifications
- Temporary booking restrictions
- Administrative review
- Suspension of reservation privileges for repeated violations

6. Equipment Status Lifecycle

The system manages equipment using the following status values:

Available

Equipment is ready for reservation.

Reserved

Equipment has an active future reservation.

Checked Out

Equipment is currently in possession of a user.

Pending Inspection

A return request has been submitted and is awaiting staff verification.

Maintenance

Equipment is temporarily unavailable due to repair, calibration, or servicing.

7. Audit Logging

The system records all major equipment events, including:

- Reservation creation
- Reservation modification
- Reservation cancellation
- Equipment checkout
- Return request submission
- Return approval
- Return rejection
- Maintenance status changes
- Administrative actions

Audit records include timestamps and responsible users to ensure accountability and traceability.

8. User Responsibilities

Users are responsible for:

- Returning equipment in the same condition in which it was received.

- Returning all accessories and components.
- Reporting damage or malfunctions immediately.
- Following all reservation and return procedures.

Users remain responsible for equipment until the return request has been inspected and approved by an authorized Administrator.

9. Policy Violations

Violations of this policy may result in:

1. Warning notification
2. Temporary suspension of reservation privileges
3. Administrative review
4. Permanent restriction on equipment usage

The severity of actions depends on the nature of the violation.

10. Policy Review

This policy shall be reviewed annually to ensure continued effectiveness and alignment with institutional requirements.